

SIX MONTHS AGO, I WROTE DOWN, “THANK YOU, UNIVERSE, FOR MAKING ME A WORLD CHAMPION”

Newly crowned World champion **Jaismine Lamboria** talks about how she manifested her win, why she views the Olympics as the starting point of her career, and why she can't afford any downtime.

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It's only been a few days since Jaismine Lamboria returned home to Bhiwani from Liverpool, where she won gold in the women's 57kg category at the Boxing World Championships. Yet she's already realising how much her world has changed. Her days have been filled with felicitations, media requests and podcast appearances. She's even been invited to meet the Prime Minister.

The scale of the reception has taken her by surprise. When she spoke to *Sportstar* just before flying out of Liverpool, the only thing she was looking forward to was

the taste of home-cooked food.

“Ghar ka khaana aur maa ke haath ka churma (Homemade food and a ghee, jaggery and wheat-based sweet dish made by her mother),” she had said.

In between all the events and appearances, Jaismine keeps her World Championships medal close. When she spoke to this publication again a few days after returning, the medal was tucked in her pocket. “I always wanted to win a gold medal for India. This medal means a lot to me. It's a reminder of the struggles and challenges that I've faced and also a motivation to do better in the future,” she says.

That motivation is why Jaismine will soon set aside the media glare and even her indulgence in *churma*. “We have another World Cup (in Delhi) in November and before that a camp in Patiala in the first week of October. I'll be going there to begin my training once again,” she says.

One might think Jaismine would

Jaismine isn't the first Indian athlete to retool her personality. Before the 2016 Olympics, badminton coach Pullela Gopichand had P. V. Sindhu yell at him in training to bring her out of her shell. For Jaismine, the breakthrough came through training methods.